



The Tripartite Architecture of Product Value

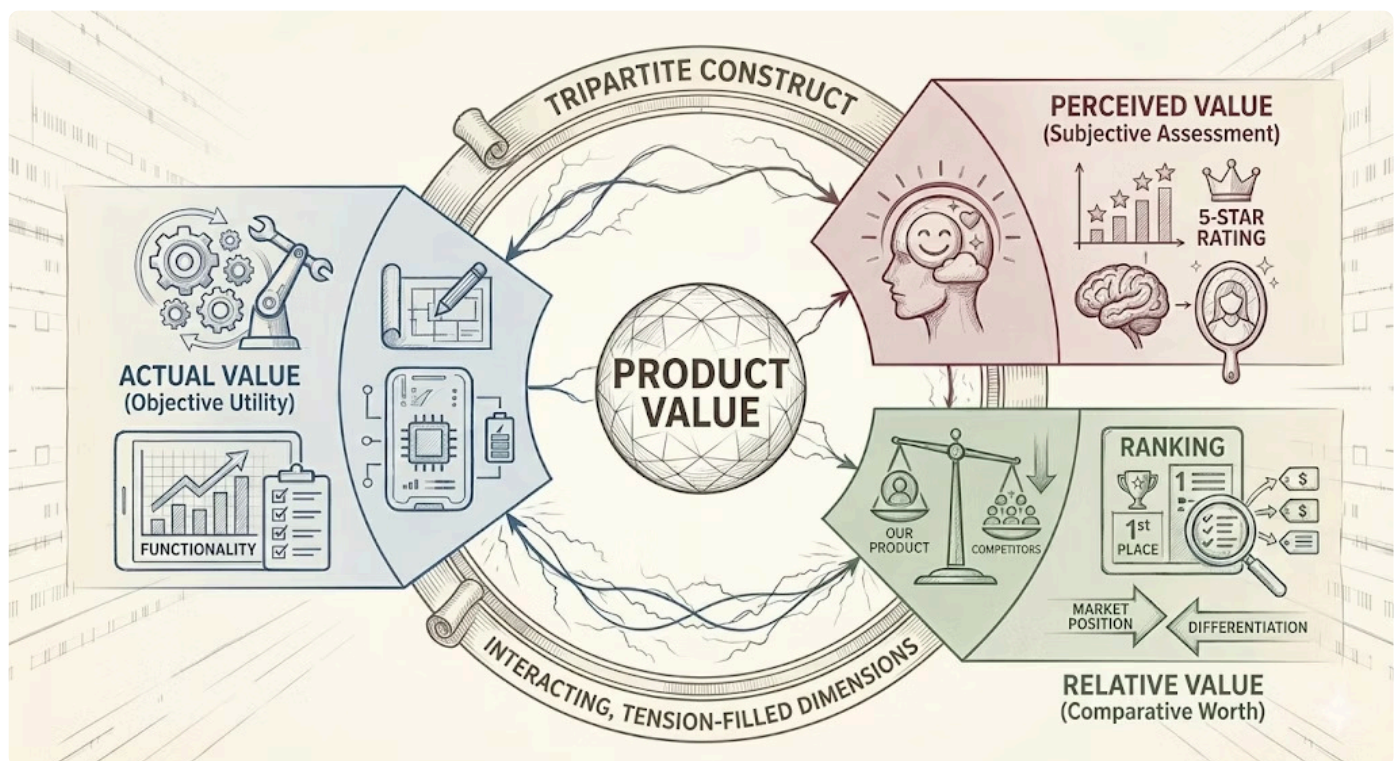
A Definitive Analysis of Actual, Perceived, and Relative Value Drivers
in Strategic Product Management

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The Crisis of Value in Modern Product Management

In the contemporary landscape of product management, the term "value" has become a semantic victim of its own ubiquity. It is referenced incessantly in roadmaps, quarterly business reviews (QBRs), and pitch decks, yet it is rarely defined with the granular precision required to operationalize it effectively. To a junior product manager, value is often synonymous with "features shipped." To a sales director, it is "revenue booked." To an engineer, it is "system performance." This fragmentation of definition leads to a fragmentation of strategy, resulting in products that may be technically brilliant but commercially disastrous, or marketing triumphs that churn users the moment reality sets in.

This paper posits that "Product Value" is not a monolithic entity but rather a tripartite construct composed of three distinct, interacting, and often tension-filled dimensions: **Actual Value** (the objective utility), **Perceived Value** (the subjective assessment), and **Relative Value** (the comparative worth).



Success in the modern market whether in SaaS, consumer electronics, or automotive innovation requires the Product Manager (PM) to act not just as a builder of features, but as an architect of this equilibrium.

The following analysis is exhaustive. This paper will dismantle each of these three pillars, exploring their theoretical underpinnings in behavioral economics and game theory, and validating these theories through deep-dive case studies of market outliers both the catastrophic failures like Juicero and the Segway, and the miraculous turnarounds like Old Spice and Slack. Furthermore, it will provide a tactical handbook of frameworks from the Kano Model to the Van Westendorp Price Sensitivity Meter that enable product leaders to quantify the unquantifiable and align their organizations around a unified theory of **value**.

1. The Anatomy of Value

To manage value, one must first dissect it. The interplay between what is built, what is believed, and what is compared forms the "Value Triad." A failure in any single leg of this stool leads to specific, predictable failure modes that have claimed countless startups and legacy lines alike.

The Three Dimensions Defined

The distinctions between these value types are not merely academic, they define the allocation of resources within a product organization.

Actual Value: The Objective Reality

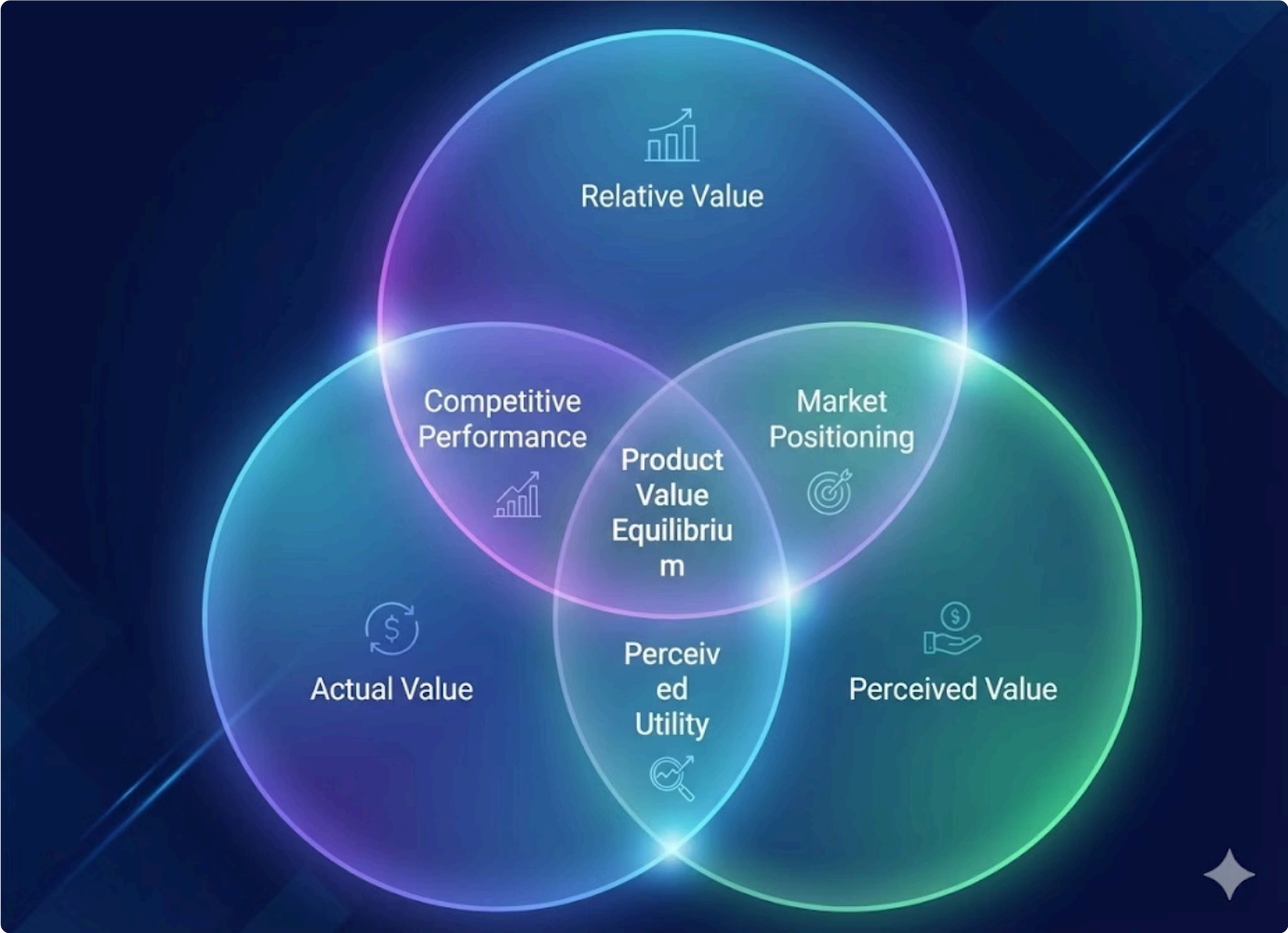
Actual Value is the foundational utility of the product. It is the "physics" of the solution, the tangible reduction in pain or the measurable increase in gain that the user experiences upon consumption. In the *Blackblot Value-Marketing Model*, Actual Value is rigorously defined as the ratio of benefits to costs that the product *factually* delivers. It is independent of the user's feelings, if a firewall blocks a cyberattack, it has delivered Actual Value, even if the user is unaware of the event.

Perceived Value: The Subjective Lens

Perceived Value is the psychology of the product. It is the customer's belief concerning the product's worth, often formed *before* the product is ever used. It is heavily influenced by heuristics, biases, social signaling, and brand reputation. A high price tag, for instance, can paradoxically increase Perceived Value in luxury goods (Veblen effect) by signaling exclusivity. Perceived Value is the gatekeeper of acquisition, without it, Actual Value remains undiscovered.

Relative Value: The Competitive Context

Relative Value is the comparative yardstick. It acknowledges that value is zero-sum in the mind of the buyer. A product with high Actual and Perceived Value can still fail if a competitor offers a solution that is marginally better or significantly cheaper. Relative Value is the domain of opportunity cost and switching barriers, governed by the "9x Effect," which states that new products must offer 9 times the value of incumbents to overcome the inertia of the status quo.



Value Dimension	Core Question	Primary Driver	Owner	Metric
Actual Value	Does it solve the problem?	Utility & Functionality	Engineering / Product	Retention, Task Success
Perceived Value	Do users <i>think</i> it's worth it?	Psychology & Brand	Marketing / Design	CAC, Conversion, NPS
Relative Value	Is it better than the alternative?	Differentiation & Context	Strategy / Sales	Market Share, Win Rate

ⓘ The PM plays the role of a conductor of an intricate orchestra in the Value Triad

2. Actual Value — The Foundation of Utility

2.1 The Economics of Solution Delivery

At its core, Actual Value is an economic exchange of utility. It represents the "Job to Be Done" (JTBD) effectively completed. For a ride-sharing app, Actual Value is the safe transport from Point A to Point B. For a B2B analytics platform, it is the actionable insight that saves money or generates revenue.

However, Actual Value is often obscured by the "Build Trap." Product teams, particularly those with heavy engineering DNA, often conflate *complexity* with *value*. They assume that because a feature was difficult to build, it must be valuable to the user. This fallacy leads to "feature factories" products bloated with high-complexity, low-utility features that dilute the core value proposition.

The Paradox of "Invisible" Utility

A critical challenge in managing Actual Value is that it is often invisible until consumption. This creates an "experience good" problem. Unlike a search good (like a t-shirt, where attributes are visible before purchase), the value of software or complex hardware is hidden behind the interface. If the interface (the vehicle for Perceived Value) is flawed, the user may never access the Actual Value.

This disconnect was the central in tragedy of the **Segway**.



- **The Engineering Triumph:** Launched in 2001, the Segway Personal Transporter (PT) was a marvel of Actual Value engineering. It utilized gyroscopic sensors to self-balance, offered zero-emission transport, and solved the "last mile" commute problem with unprecedented efficiency.
- **The Contextual Failure:** Despite this high utility, the Segway failed because its Actual Value was incompatible with the physical world. It was too fast for sidewalks (endangering pedestrians) and too slow for roads (endangering riders). Furthermore, it was too heavy to carry into offices. The Actual Value existed in a vacuum, disconnected from the infrastructure of daily life.
- **The Lesson:** Actual Value is not just about the product's capabilities, it is about the product's fit within the user's environment. Utility that cannot be accessed or integrated is functionally zero.

2.2 Metrics that Matter: Measuring the Intangible

Because Actual Value is objective, it demands rigorous measurement. Vanity metrics (likes, page views) must be discarded in favor of outcome-based metrics.

1. **Task Success Rate:** In AI and ML products, for example, "model accuracy" is a technical metric. The Actual Value metric is "Task Success Rate" the percentage of times the user achieved their goal using the model.
2. **Time-to-Value (TTV):** This measures the friction between acquisition and value realization. A low TTV indicates that Actual Value is highly accessible. Products like **Canva** excel here by dropping users directly into a creation flow, minimizing the barrier to Actual Value.
3. **Outcome-Based Pricing:** The ultimate test of Actual Value is the ability to price based on outcomes rather than access. Pricing per "lead generated" or "transaction processed" aligns the incentives of the buyer and seller, ensuring that revenue is a direct function of the Actual Value delivered.

3. Perceived Value — The Psychological Lens

3.1 The Subjective Reality of Worth

If Actual Value is the physics of the product, Perceived Value is the alchemy. It is the transmutation of features into feelings. Perceived Value is often defined as the difference between the prospective customer's evaluation of all benefits and all costs of an offering and the perceived alternatives.

This dimension is critical because humans are rarely rational economic actors. We are influenced by "irrational" drivers such as social status, fear of missing out (FOMO), and aesthetic preferences. A product manager who ignores Perceived Value is leaving the product's fate to chance.

3.2 The Drivers of Perception

Perceived Value is manipulated through several key levers that operate independently of the product's codebase or hardware.

The Signaling Power of Price

Price is a quality signal. In the absence of perfect information, consumers use price as a proxy for value. This phenomenon, known as the **Veblen Effect** in luxury markets, suggests that demand can actually increase as price increases because the higher price confers status and assumes quality. Conversely, pricing a product too low can be fatal.

Case Study: Tata Nano



The Tata Nano was engineered to be the "People's Car" of India, a triumph of frugal engineering with high Actual Value for families upgrading from two-wheelers. However, its marketing strategy hinged entirely on it being the "World's Cheapest Car" (approx. \$2500). This positioning destroyed its Perceived Value. In an aspirational economy, owning the "cheapest" car was a badge of poverty, not prudence. Consumers refused to buy it because the social cost (negative Perceived Value) outweighed the transportation benefit (Actual Value).

Brand Equity and The Halo Effect

Strong branding creates a "halo effect" where specific attributes of a product are assumed to be superior because of the overall reputation of the manufacturer. **Apple** leverages this masterfully, a new iPhone feature is perceived as "revolutionary" even if competitors have had it for years, simply because the Perceived Value of the Apple ecosystem is so high. This allows for premium pricing strategies that disconnect price from the strict cost of goods sold.

Onboarding as a Perception Driver

For software, the first 5 minutes of usage, onboarding are where Perceived Value is cemented. If a user feels confused or overwhelmed, the Perceived Value drops to zero, regardless of the tool's power.

Case Study: Slack Slack's onboarding is playful, conversational, and guided. It uses "empty states" to teach users how to use the product, injecting personality (Perceived Value) into what is essentially an IRC chat client (Actual Value). This high Perceived Value allows Slack to charge a premium over competitors, which offered similar utility but a sterile, "corporate" experience.

3.3 The "Hype Bubble": The Dangers of Excess Perception

When Perceived Value significantly outpaces Actual Value, a product enters a "Hype Bubble." While this can drive massive initial sales, it inevitably leads to a crash when the reality of the Actual Value becomes apparent. This creates a "debt" of trust that is often impossible to repay.

Case Study: Juicero



Perhaps the most infamous example of the 21st century, Juicero raised over \$120 million by selling a \$700 Wi-Fi-connected juice press. The Perceived Value was built on the promise of "raw, organic, cold-pressed juice at home" with Silicon Valley aesthetics.

The Crash: The bubble burst when *Bloomberg* revealed that the proprietary juice packs could be squeezed by hand just as effectively as the machine. The Actual Value of the \$700 hardware was effectively zero. The gap between the premium perception and the nonexistent reality led to the company's immediate collapse and ridicule.

Case Study: Cyberpunk 2077



CD Projekt Red marketed *Cyberpunk 2077* as a generation-defining RPG, creating immense Perceived Value through celebrity endorsements (Keanu Reeves) and cinematic trailers.

The Crash: At launch, the Actual Value was marred by game-breaking bugs and poor performance on last-gen consoles. The resulting dissonance caused a 75% drop in stock value, mass refunds, and the game's removal from the PlayStation Store. While they eventually improved the Actual Value through patches, the initial perception gap caused long-term reputational damage.

3.4 Managing Perception: The Old Spice Turnaround

Perceived Value is not static, it can be engineered. **Old Spice** serves as the definitive case study for rebranding.

- **The Problem:** The product (Actual Value) was fine effective deodorant, but the Perceived Value was toxic to younger generations. It was seen as a "grandfather's brand."
- **The Strategy:** They did not change the product formula. Instead, they launched the "Smell Like a Man" campaign, which used humor and surrealism to re-contextualize the brand.
- **The Result:** By changing *only* the Perceived Value, sales increased by 125%. This proves that a product's commercial performance can be transformed without touching a single line of code or chemical ingredient.

4. Relative Value — The Competitive Context

Relative Value is the hardest hurdle to clear because it involves overcoming human inertia. It is not enough for a new product to be better than the old one, it must be *significantly* better to justify the cost of switching.

4.1 The 9x Effect: Why "Better" Isn't Enough

John Gourville's "9x Effect" provides the mathematical framework for this challenge.

- **Consumer Bias (3x):** Consumers overvalue their existing solution by a factor of 3 due to the **Endowment Effect** (we value what we own more than what we don't) and **Loss Aversion** (the pain of giving up the old solution is greater than the pleasure of getting the new one).
- **Innovator Bias (3x):** Product managers overvalue their new solution by a factor of 3 because they are intimately familiar with its benefits and often ignore the learning curve required to adopt it.
- **The Multiplier:** $3 \times 3 = 9$. The new product must offer 9 times the value of the incumbent to generate a switch.

This explains why incremental improvements fail. If a new CRM is 20% better than Salesforce, it will fail. The switching costs (data migration, retraining staff, risk of downtime) vastly outweigh a 20% gain in Actual Value.

4.2 The Battle of UX: Zoom vs. Webex

In commoditized markets, Relative Value often shifts from "feature set" to "user experience" (UX). The video conferencing wars provide a stark example.

- **The Incumbent: Webex** (and Skype) dominated the corporate market. They had high Actual Value, robust security, deep integration with Cisco hardware, and enterprise reliability.
- **The Challenger: Zoom.** Feature-wise (Actual Value), Zoom was largely identical to Webex: video, audio, screen sharing.
- **The Relative Advantage:** Zoom focused maniacally on *friction reduction*. While Webex required logins, plugins, and complex dial-ins, Zoom worked with a single link. It "just worked." This ease of use created a Relative Value advantage that was perceived as 9x better than the "pain" of setting up a Webex call. Zoom won not by adding features, but by removing friction.

4.3 The Freemium Lever: Slack vs. HipChat

Pricing models are a potent lever for Relative Value. **Slack** competed against **HipChat**, which was the established player.

- **HipChat:** Priced at roughly \$2/user/month. Functional, utilitarian.
- **Slack:** Priced at roughly \$6-\$12/user/month. Significantly more expensive.
- **The Strategy:** Despite the higher price, Slack won on Relative Value through a robust **freemium model**. This lowered the barrier to entry to zero, allowing teams to experience the Actual Value (and get hooked on the delightful UX/Perceived Value) before paying a dime. By the time the paywall hit, the Endowment Effect had kicked in, users didn't want to lose their message history. HipChat's lower price couldn't compete with "Free to start, delightful to use".

5. The Strategic Interplay — The Value Matrix

To effectively manage these levers, a Product Manager must visualize their product's position in the market. The interaction of Actual Value, Perceived Value and Relative Value creates a strategic cube.

5.1 The Value Cube

1. X-Axis: Actual Value (Utility)

- *Question:* Does the product work?
- *Range:* Dysfunction to High-Performance Utility.

2. Y-Axis: Perceived Value (Sentiment)

- *Question:* Do users want it?
- *Range:* Indifference to Obsession.

3. Z-Axis: Relative Value (Differentiation)

- *Question:* Is it unique?
- *Range:* Commodity (Many substitutes) to Monopoly (No substitutes).

5.2 The Eight Strategic Octants

By crossing these three dimensions (Low vs. High), we identify eight distinct strategic states. The addition of the Z-axis reveals why "good" products often fail to generate "great" profits:

Commoditization.

1. The "Golden Goose" (High Actual / High Perceived / High Relative)

- **The State:** The product works flawlessly, users love the brand, and there are no viable alternatives.
- **Characteristics:** Infinite pricing power, viral growth, deep moats.
- **Strategy: Fortification.** Aggressively protect the differentiation (Z-axis) through ecosystem lock-in or patents.
- **Example: Nvidia Chips (2023-2024).** High utility for AI, massive brand hype, and effectively zero competition at the high end.

2. The "Commodity Trap" (High Actual / High Perceived / Low Relative)

- **The State:** This is the most dangerous state for mature products. The product is excellent and well-liked, but the market is flooded with identical substitutes.
- **Characteristics:** High volume but eroding margins. Success depends entirely on marketing spend or price cutting.
- **Strategy: Differentiation or Cost Leadership.** You must either invent a new feature to move up the Z-axis or slash costs to survive the price war.
- **Example: Android Handsets (Samsung/Pixel).** Great tech (Actual), strong brands (Perceived), but high interchangeability (Low Relative) forces constant fierce competition, unlike Apple's walled garden.¹

3. The "Best Kept Secret" (High Actual / Low Perceived / High Relative)

- **The State:** A niche technical marvel. It solves a unique problem better than anyone else, but nobody knows about it, or the UI is intimidating.
- **Characteristics:** Low growth, intensely loyal but small user base.
- **Strategy: Evangelism.** Do not touch the code (X and Z are fine). Invest 100% of resources into Marketing and UX (Y-axis) to unlock the value.
- **Example: Linux (Consumer Desktop).** Unmatched stability and control (High Actual), unique open-source nature (High Relative), but historically poor perception among average users due to complexity (Low Perceived).

4. The "Paper Tiger" (Low Actual / High Perceived / High Relative)

- **The State:** A "First Mover" with a great story but broken tech. The world *thinks* it's the only solution to a big problem.
- **Characteristics:** Massive short-term valuation, imminent collapse.
- **Strategy: Emergency Engineering.** The company is living on borrowed time. It must fix the product (X-axis) before the market realizes the emperor has no clothes.
- **Example: Theranos.** The promise was unique (High Relative) and the story was compelling (High Perceived), but the tech didn't work (Low Actual).

5. The "Incumbent's Dilemma" (High Actual / Low Perceived / Low Relative)

- **The State:** Boring, functional enterprise software. It works, but users hate using it, and there are 10 other tools just like it.
- **Characteristics:** High churn risk. Vulnerable to a "Design Disruptor" (like Linear or Slack).
- **Strategy: UX Overhaul.** The utility is there, but the "delight" is missing.
- **Example: Jira (Legacy).** Powerful (High Actual), but often viewed as "bloated" (Low Perceived) and facing pressure from agile tools (Low Relative).

6. The "Fool's Gold" (Low Actual / High Perceived / Low Relative)

- **The State:** Hype-driven dropshipping products.
- **Characteristics:** Quick sales, massive returns, zero retention.
- **Strategy: Cash Cow & Kill.** These businesses rarely survive long-term.
- **Example: Fidget Spinners (Late Stage).** High initial desire, low utility, infinite copycats.

7. The "Zombie" (Low Actual / Low Perceived / High Relative)

- **The State:** A product that doesn't work well and no one likes, but it's the *only* option available (often due to government regulation or legacy lock-in).
- **Characteristics:** Resented by users. Survives only due to lack of choice.
- **Strategy: Pivot or Perish.** The moment a competitor appears (Z-axis shifts), this product dies instantly.
- **Example: Cable TV Interfaces (Pre-Streaming).** Terrible UX, hated by users, but the only way to watch content until Netflix arrived.

8. The "Dead Zone" (Low Actual / Low Perceived / Low Relative)

- **The State:** Bad product, bad brand, many alternatives.
- **Characteristics:** Bankruptcy.
- **Example: Quibi.**

5.3 Navigating the Z-Axis: The Moat

The most difficult movement in the Cube is along the Z-axis (Relative Value). Moving from "Commodity" (Low Relative) to "Monopoly" (High Relative) requires creating a **Moat**.

1. **The Data Moat:** The product gets better the more people use it (e.g., Waze, TikTok). This increases Actual Value *relative* to competitors who lack the data.
2. **The Switching Cost Moat:** The pain of leaving is higher than the gain of switching (e.g., Salesforce, ERP systems). This artificially inflates Relative Value by penalizing the alternative.
3. **The Brand Moat:** The brand becomes a "Veblen Good" where the price itself signals value, detaching it from direct comparison with cheaper alternatives (e.g., Supreme, Rolex).

5.4 Summary: The PM's 3D Coordinate System

A Product Manager must be able to plot their product's coordinates (x, y, z) in this cube at any given time:

$$\text{Total Value} = \sum (X - \text{Actual Value}, Y - \text{Perceived Value}, Z - \text{Relative Value})$$

- If X is low: **Fix the product.**
- If Y is low: **Fix the story.**
- If Z is low: **Fix the strategy.**

6. Operational Frameworks — The Product Manager's Toolkit

Understanding value concepts is theoretical, measuring and prioritizing them is operational. A Product Manager must use specific frameworks to quantify these abstract drivers and make roadmap decisions.

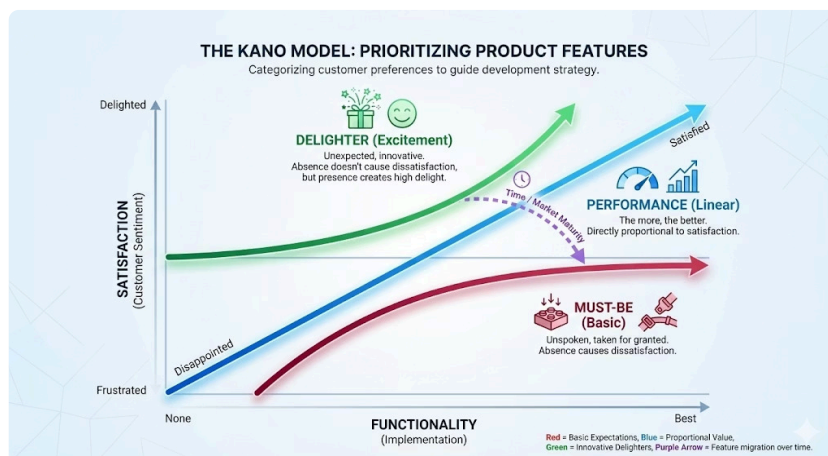
6.1 Prioritizing Actual Value: The Kano Model

Not all features contribute to Actual Value equally. The **Kano Model** is essential for distinguishing between what users *say* they want and what actually drives satisfaction.

The Three Categories of Features

1. **Must-Be Attributes (Thresholds):** These features are binary. If they are absent, the user is dissatisfied (Actual Value = 0). If they are present, the user is neutral (satisfaction does not increase).
 - *Example:* A car having wheels. A messaging app sending texts.
 - *Strategy:* Implement to industry standards, then stop. Do not over-invest here.
2. **Performance Attributes (Linear):** These features have a linear relationship with satisfaction. The "more" you give, the happier the user.
 - *Example:* Battery life, internet speed, storage space.
 - *Strategy:* These are the battlegrounds for Relative Value. Invest here to differentiate.
3. **Delighters (Attractive):** These are unexpected features. If absent, the user doesn't care (because they didn't expect them). If present, satisfaction skyrockets.
 - *Example:* Free cookies at a hotel check-in. The "confetti" animation when you complete a task in Asana.
 - *Strategy:* These drive Perceived Value and word-of-mouth. Include at least one in every major release.

How to Run a Kano Study:



- Ask two questions for every feature:
 - a. **Functional:** "How would you feel if the product **had** this feature?"
 - b. **Dysfunctional:** "How would you feel if the product **did not have** this feature?"
- Map the answers on the Kano grid to categorize the feature.

6.2 Measuring Perceived Value & Pricing: Van Westendorp PSM

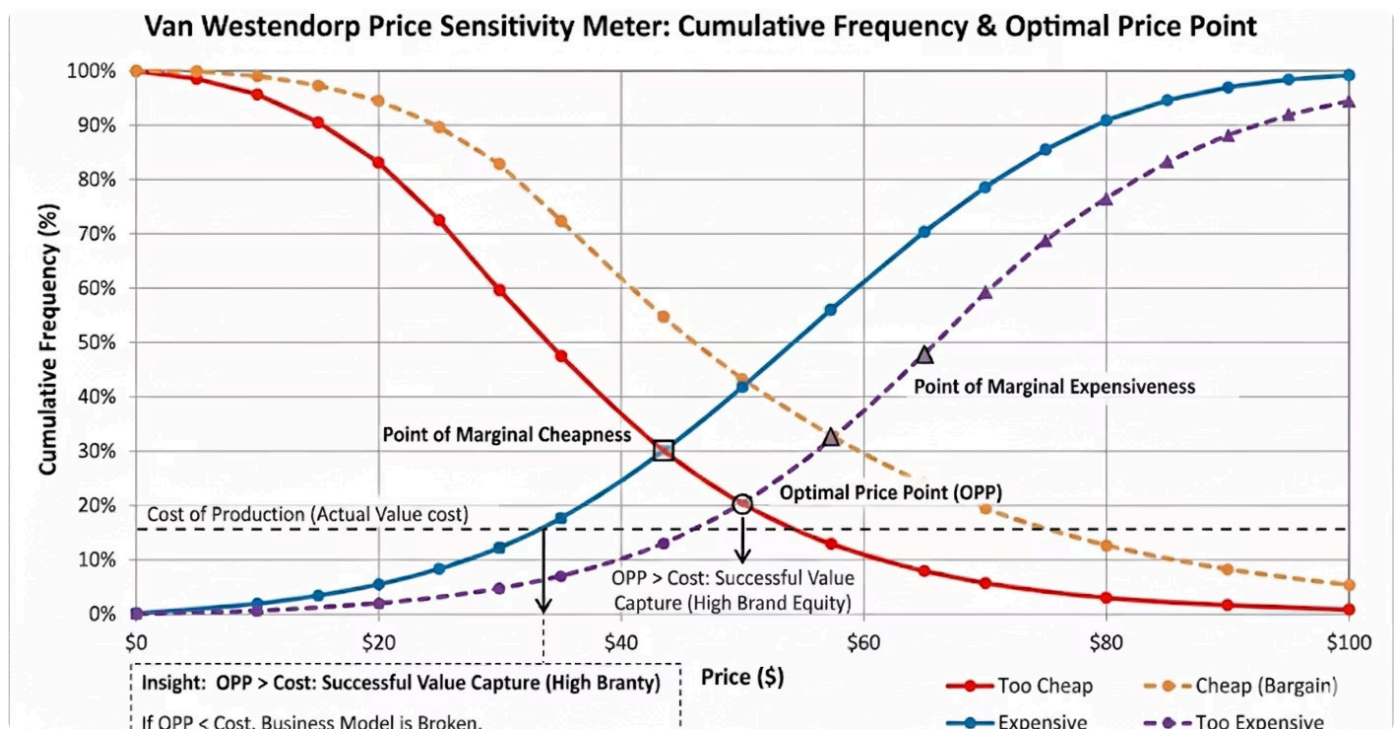
Determining the monetary value of Perception is difficult. Direct questions ("How much would you pay?") yield biased data. The **Van Westendorp Price Sensitivity Meter (PSM)** helps identify the "optimal price point" where Perceived Value aligns with willingness to pay.

The Four Questions:

1. At what price is the product so cheap you doubt its quality? (**Too Cheap**)
2. At what price is it a bargain? (**Cheap**)
3. At what price does it get expensive, but you'd still consider it? (**Expensive**)
4. At what price is it too expensive? (**Too Expensive**)

Interpretation:

- Plot the cumulative frequency of the answers.
- The intersection of "Too Cheap" and "Expensive" creates the **Point of Marginal Cheapness**.
- The intersection of "Too Expensive" and "Cheap" creates the **Point of Marginal Expensiveness**.
- The **Optimal Price Point (OPP)** is typically where the "Too Cheap" and "Too Expensive" curves intersect.
- **Insight:** If your OPP is lower than your cost of production (Actual Value cost), your business model is fundamentally broken. If the OPP is significantly higher, you have high Perceived Value (Brand Equity) that you are successfully capturing.

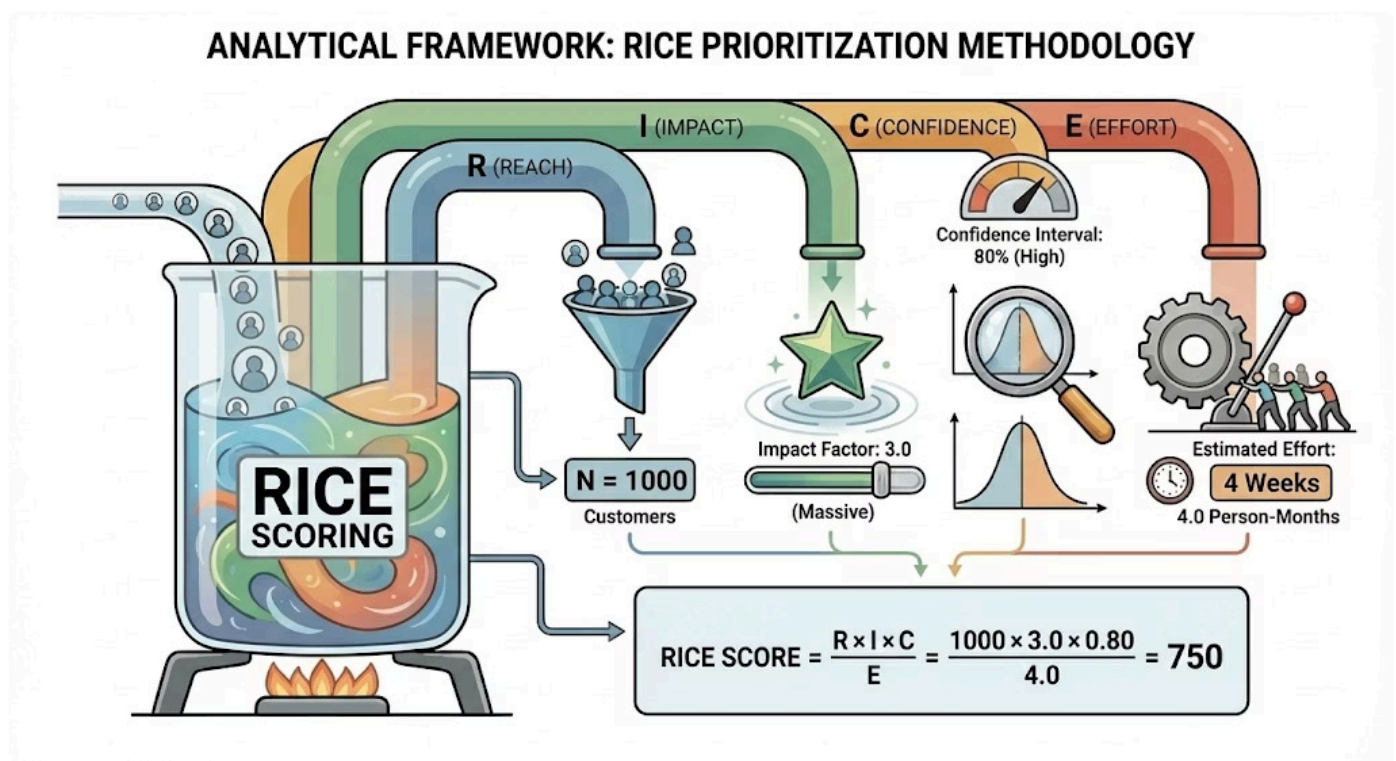


6.3 Calculating Relative ROI: RICE Scoring

When deciding which value lever to pull, the **RICE Scoring** model provides a formulaic approach to prioritization, preventing the loudest voice in the room from dictating the roadmap.

RICE Score = [Reach X Impact X Confidence] / [Effort]

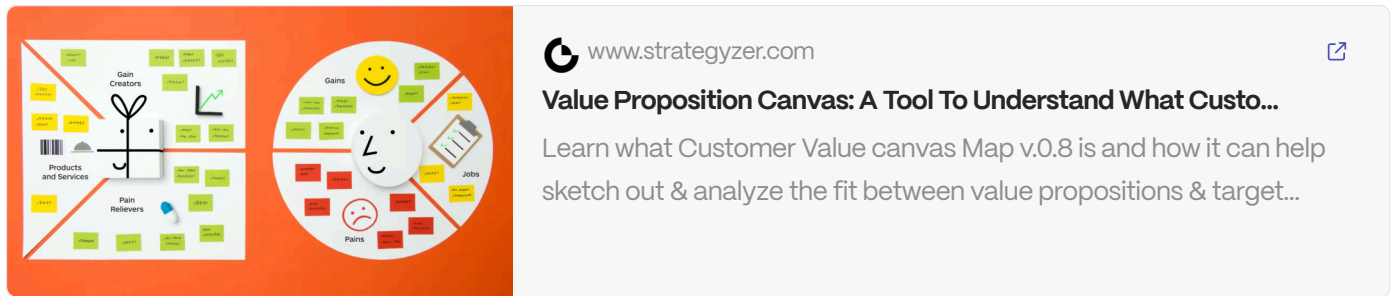
- **Reach:** How many users will this feature affect? (Proxy for Market Share/Relative Value)
- **Impact:** How much will it increase the user's utility? (Proxy for Actual Value)
 - *Scale:* 3 (Massive), 2 (High), 1 (Medium), 0.5 (Low), 0.25 (Minimal).
- **Confidence:** How sure are we about these estimates? (Risk adjustment).
 - *Scale:* 100% (High confidence/Data backed), 80% (Medium), 50% (Low).
- **Effort:** How many "person-months" will it take? (Cost).



Why it matters: RICE forces PMs to confront the "Effort" denominator. A feature with high Perceived Value (Impact) might be deprioritized if the Effort is massive, in favor of a "quick win" that delivers moderate value for minimal effort.

6.4 The Value Proposition Canvas

Developed by Strategyzer, this framework ensures that the product's features (Actual Value) map directly to the customer's psychology (Perceived Value).



The Two Sides:

1. Customer Profile (Circle):

- **Customer Jobs:** What are they trying to do?
- **Pains:** What annoys them or prevents them from doing the job?
- **Gains:** What outcomes do they desire?

2. Value Map (Square):

- **Products & Services:** What are you building?
- **Pain Relievers:** How does it eliminate Pains?
- **Gain Creators:** How does it create Gains?

The Fit: Actual Value exists *only* when a Gain Creator matches a Customer Gain or a Pain Reliever matches a Customer Pain. If you build a feature that doesn't map to a Pain or Gain, you are building waste.

7. Conclusion — The Equilibrium of Value

The role of the Product Manager is not merely to "ship code." It is to act as the arbitrageur between what is built (Actual Value), how it is marketed (Perceived Value), and how it survives competition (Relative Value).

History provides us with a clear rubric for this equilibrium:

- **Actual Value** is the engine. Without it, you stall (Segway).
- **Perceived Value** is the fuel. Without it, you never start (Tata Nano).
- **Relative Value** is the navigation. Without it, you get lost in the crowd (HipChat).

The most successful products of our time—iPhone, Slack, Zoom, did not just excel in one area. They maintained a dynamic tension between all three. They built robust utility, wrapped it in compelling stories, and positioned it cleverly against incumbents.

For the modern Product Manager, the mandate is clear. Stop viewing value as a single metric. Break it down. Measure the Actual with retention. Measure the Perceived with willingness-to-pay. Measure the Relative with win-rates. And then, architect your roadmap to close the gaps.

Key Takeaway Summary Table

Concept	Definition	Key Metric	Failure Mode	Success Strategy
Actual Value	Objective utility and outcome delivery.	Retention, Task Success, TTV.	Churn: Users buy but don't stay (e.g., Cyberpunk 2077 launch).	Focus on "Jobs to be Done" and core stability.
Perceived Value	Subjective worth and brand sentiment.	CAC, Conversion Rate, NPS.	Low Adoption: Users never try it (e.g., Tata Nano).	Marketing alignment, better onboarding, social proof.
Relative Value	Comparative advantage vs. alternatives.	Market Share, Win/Loss Ratio.	Commoditization: Pricing wars (e.g., Webex vs. Zoom).	Differentiation, high switching costs, niche focus.

Source

Here is the list of research sources used for this white paper.

Source	Article	URL
Productboard	Do you really understand the concept of product value?	Link
Blackblot	Value-Marketing Model	Link
Simon-Kucher	Value Perception: Understand and Enhance Your Products	Link
Harvard Business Review	Eager Sellers and Stony Buyers (The 9x Effect)	Link
Berghahn Journals	Segway High Actual Value Low Perceived Value Failure Analysis	Link
Blue Ocean Strategy	Segway Case Study: Avoiding the Fate of the Segway Electric Scooter	Link
Pepper Content	Why Tata Nano Branding Was a Failure	Link
Autoweek	The Tata Nano Failed Because Nobody Aspires to Own a 'Cheap' Car	Link
Estes Media	The Psychology of Rebranding: Aligning Perception with Reality (Old Spice Case Study)	Link
Peter Alkema	The Demise of Juicero: Case Study of Failed Technology Disruption	Link
Score India	Domino's Pizza Turnaround: Brand Crisis Recovery	Link
Dennis Food Service	Domino's Pizza Turnaround Case Study	Link
Game Informer	A Week With The Upgraded No Man's Sky (Redemption Arc)	Link
AccessVP	Pricing Strategy: Slack vs. HipChat	Link
LarkSuite	Webex vs. Zoom: A Comprehensive Comparison	Link
Cascade	The Dyson Strategy: How Dyson Sells Premium Products	Link

Source	Article	URL
Folding Burritos	The Complete Guide to the Kano Model	Link
Qualtrics	Van Westendorp Price Sensitivity Meter Explained	Link
HelloPM	What is RICE Scoring? A Prioritization Framework	Link
Strategyzer	The Value Proposition Canvas	Link